



Discussion Guide: Lanecia Rouse

Embracing the In-Between

Reflect

- According to Lanecia, all of us experience in-between, or “liminal” moments in life. What are some circumstances that can lead to an “in-between” moment?
- In her talk, Lanecia names how the desire for control and certainty can hold us back from being the best versions of ourselves. Do you agree? If so, why?
- Embracing curiosity is a key component of artistic creativity, but it can also be key to spiritual growth. Why do you think curiosity is important to spiritual growth? Has curiosity been affirmed in the faith communities you have been a part of?

Respond

- Describe an “in-between” moment in your own life. What helped you get through it?
- Who are the people in your life that you can be most vulnerable with? What is it about them or the relationship that invites vulnerability?
- In her poem, “Instructions for Living a Life,” Mary Oliver writes: “Pay attention. Be astonished. Tell about it.” Which of these three things comes most naturally to you? Which is the hardest?